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FREE CHECKLIST · 2026 EDITION

Online Business Tools Checklist

There is so much advice out there that it is easy to feel lost and not know where to start your online business. You do not need a big budget or technical skills to begin. You just...



6 pages · PDF

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What's inside

3 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

01 Your Online Store and Selling Foundation

02 Getting Products and Keeping Track of Stock

03 Marketing and Getting Your First Sales

There is so much advice out there that it is easy to feel lost and not know where to start your online business. You do not need a big budget or technical skills to begin. You just need the right set of tools.

This guide is your simple, beginner-friendly tools checklist. We have picked useful, good-quality tools that are free to start or have cheap starter plans, and that work for sellers in Nigeria. Let us break your launch into small, clear steps.

01 Your Online Store and Selling Foundation

First, you need a shop on the internet. This is where you list your products and receive orders. Choose something easy to use that does not need any coding.

Your top priority is an online store builder. This is one service that lets you build your website, add products and collect payments.

- Shopinbos: Built for Nigerian sellers. Rex, the AI store builder, creates your store for you. Customers can pay with Paystack, Flutterwave, bank transfer, USSD or pay on delivery, and you get payouts to your Nigerian bank account every Friday. It is free to start; see shopinbos.com/pricing.
- Shopify: A popular store builder with an easy drag-and-drop editor. It has a free trial, then a monthly plan billed in US dollars, so you will need a card that works for dollar payments.
- WooCommerce: A free plugin that turns a WordPress website into a store. It is powerful and flexible, but you need a WordPress site first, which means paying for web hosting and doing more setup yourself.
- Selling on social media: Many Nigerian sellers start on WhatsApp Business, Instagram, TikTok or Facebook, and on marketplaces like Jiji, Jumia and Konga. These are great for reaching people, but a store of your own gives you one link where customers can see everything and pay safely.

Actionable Step: If you want the simplest path, start with a free store on Shopinbos and share your store link on WhatsApp and Instagram the same day.

02 Getting Products and Keeping Track of Stock

Now, let us get your products ready. Whether you make items yourself, buy in bulk from Balogun, Trade Fair, Alaba or Kano markets, or dropship from a supplier, you need a way to keep track of everything.

You need a simple way to know how many of each item you have left, so you never sell something that is already finished. This is a key part of any tools checklist.

- Google Sheets or Excel: Do not underrate a well-organised spreadsheet. It is free and flexible. List your products, count your stock and work out your costs. This is a great place to start.

- Nigerian suppliers on Shopinbos: Find verified Nigerian suppliers and choose dropship (the supplier sends the item to your customer after you sell it, so you hold no stock) or wholesale (you buy in bulk at a lower price). This is a good way to test products without tying up your money.
- Built-in stock tools: Before paying for a separate app, use the stock features inside your store builder. Shopinbos tracks orders, stock and deliveries in one place, and Shopify and WooCommerce also have basic stock tools.

Actionable Step: List your first 5–10 products in a Google Sheet with columns for Product Name, Cost (₦), Selling Price (₦) and Quantity. For example: "Shea butter 250g, ₦1,800, ₦3,500, 40".

03 Marketing and Getting Your First Sales

Your store is live and stocked. Now you need customers. The goal is to get seen without spending a lot on adverts.

You do not need a complicated marketing plan on day one. Focus on the basics of getting people's attention.

- WhatsApp Business: Most of your customers are already on WhatsApp. Set up a catalogue, quick replies and broadcast lists for people who agreed to hear from you. Peggy, the Shopinbos AI assistant, can help you reply to chats faster.
- Mailchimp or Brevo: Good tools for email. Both have free plans with limits on how many contacts and emails you can have. Collect emails from your store and send updates. A list of customers you can contact directly is one of the most valuable things your business can own.
- Canva: A very easy design tool. Make social media posts, store banners and flyers without any design experience. The free version has lots of templates.
- Meta Business Suite and Instagram/Facebook shops: Post, reply to messages and see your results for Facebook and Instagram in one place. Shops let people see your products right on your profile.

Actionable Step: Create a free Canva account and design a simple graphic to announce your store launch on your WhatsApp Status, Instagram and TikTok.

Your Simple Tools Checklist

Use this as a quick check that you have the basics covered:

- Store Builder: Signed up for Shopinbos, Shopify or WooCommerce.
- Product List: Created a simple stock spreadsheet with prices in naira.
- Payments: Turned on Paystack, Flutterwave, bank transfer or pay on delivery in your store.
- Business Registration: Started your CAC business name registration and have a business bank account (you will need your BVN).

- WhatsApp and Email: Set up WhatsApp Business and a Mailchimp or Brevo account, with a sign-up form on your store.
- Design Tool: Created a Canva account for your marketing pictures.
- Stock Management: Turned on the stock tools in your store builder or set up your spreadsheet.

Remember, the goal is to start simple. You can always upgrade and add better tools as your business grows. The most important step is to begin.

Feeling more confident but want someone to guide you? At Shopinbos, we help you take these first steps without the confusion. Explore our step-by-step guides and find the right tools for your business.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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